



LOYOLA UNIVERSITY CHICAGO

Introduction to Computing

MODULE 1: DIGITAL INFORMATION

Outlines

HISTORY OF COMPUTERS

We will talk about the different generations of computers and how they changed the way we solve problems.

CODING AND PROGRAMMING

We will talk about computer programs and how they communicate with the hardware. We talk about operating systems and their components

WORKING WITH BINARY

We will talk about how data is represented in a computer system, and how binary bits build larger units to process, store, and transmit information.

History of Computers

- There are different generations of computing devices.
- Computer generations are characterized by major technological developments that altered the way computers operate.
 - More computational power.
 - More reliability.
 - More efficiency
 - Smaller in size.
 - Cheaper
 - Etc.

First Generation

1940-1956

Vacuum Tubes

Third Generation

1964-1971

Integrated circuits

Future Generation

Second Generation

1956-1963

Transistors

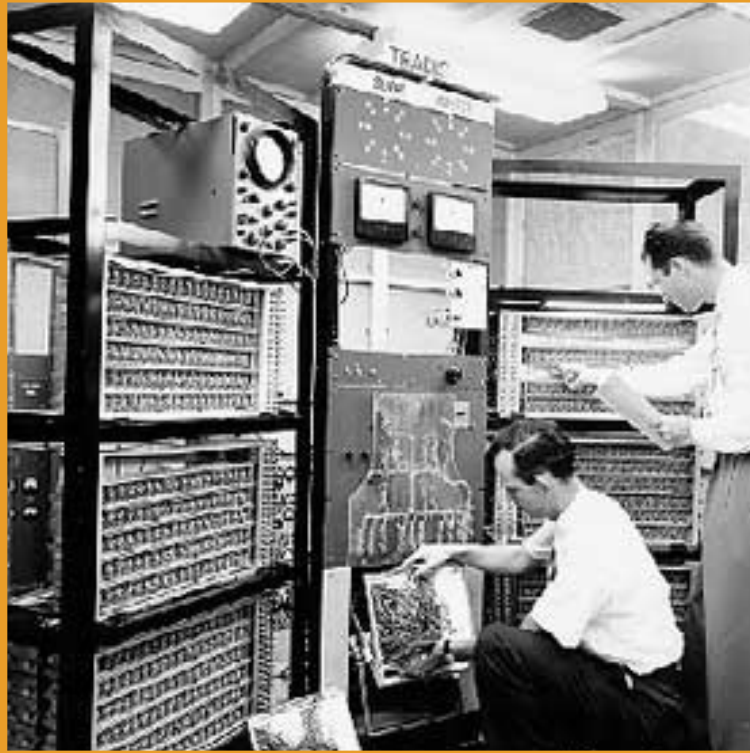
Fourth Generation

1971-Present

Microprocessors

VLSI & ULSI





- Vacuum tube technology
- Unreliable
- Machine language only
- Very costly
- Generated a lot of heat
- Slow input and output devices
- Huge size - Non-portable
- Consumed a lot of electricity

- ENIAC
- EDVAC
- UNIVAC
- IBM-701
- IBM-650



- Use of transistors
- More Reliable
- Smaller size
- Less heat
- Consumed less electricity
- Faster
- Still very costly
- Machine & assembly languages

- IBM 1620
- IBM 7094
- CDC 1604
- CDC 3600
- UNIVAC 1108



- Use of IC
- More Reliable
- Smaller size
- Less heat
- Consumed less electricity
- Faster
- Still costly
- High-level languages

- IBM-360 series
- Honeywell-6000 series
- PDP (Personal Data Processor)
- IBM-370/168
- TDC-316



- VLSI - Very Large Scale Integration
- ULSI - Ultra Large Scale Integration
- Smaller size
- Less heat
- Consumed less electricity
- Faster
- Cheaper
- High-level languages

- Desktop
- Laptop
- NoteBook
- UltraBook
- ChromeBook

EXAMPLES

Impact of Innovation

The impact of the innovation of computers and computer science extends far beyond the computer.

MEDICINE

Robotics and sensors are used to enter the body and detect medical conditions that would otherwise have gone unnoticed

ART AND FASHION

Computers are used to build 3D printed clothing, pieces of art, music, patterns and more.

TRANSPORTATION

Computers inform cities on how to best configure train and bus routes, timing of traffic, and the number of lanes needed to reduce congestion.

CODING AND PROGRAMMING

Programs are what allow the hardware to come alive.

This can happen at many levels

- **Operating System:**

- Communicate directly to the hardware components.
 - e.g., CPU, Memory, and Input/output devices.
- Used to be very simple (**text terminal**), and it has become very sophisticated.
 - Examples: macOS, Linux, Windows, iOS and Android.
- Defines file formatting systems to store information.
- Defines the way programs (applications) access the hardware.
 - This is done using **API** (Application Programming Interface).
- Provides a set of tools that allow programmers to build applications.
 - These tools are called **SDKs** (Software Development Kits).

SDK



- The SDKs include three basic parts.
 - Pre-built sets of code.
 - Define ways to work with numbers, arithmetic, and the file system.
 - Defines the user interface controls
 - i.e., buttons and windows
 - Defines ways to navigate and use the hardware
 - e.g., keyboard, mouse, touch, motion or other sensors.
 - Programming language.
 - Interpreter or compiler.

THE INTERPRETER

- The interpreter takes written code and translates it to instructions.
- From language programmers understand to language machines understand.
- Operates live (line by line) on script languages (interpreted languages) -
 - Most of these languages use an intermediate representation
 - i.e., combines compiling and interpreting.
- Example: Python and JavaScript

THE COMPILER



- The compiler takes all the program and converts it all to machine code.
- Compiled programs tend to be faster than running a script.
- Multiple levels of optimization can be used.
- Changes to the program require re-compilation.
- Example: C, C++, and Java



Everything you run on a device
needs to be translated to the
machine language.

Writing a novel, composing music, texting/typing, playing a game,
analyzing data, and all other applications (including the OS).



MACHINE LANGUAGE WORKING WITH BINARY

BINARY SYSTEM

- Binary system has only two possible states.
 - On/Off - True/False - 1/0
- Binary state can be represented with:
 - Boolean value (True or False)
 - Number (1 or 0)
- Data can be stored and communicated using **on** or **off** states.
- Logic gates in microchips use electricity to capture the **on** and **off** signals.
- Storage devices and networks save binary states and communicate them.
- Single state is called a **bit**, which is used to build larger and more complicated data units.

BINARY: UNITS

- Using binary bits as basic unit, data is represented as a string of bits.
- Eight binary digits is called a **byte**, which is a common measure of data.

Bit	Byte	Kilobyte	Megabyte	Gigabyte	Terabyte
	8 bits	1,024 bytes	1,024 kilobytes	1,024 megabytes	1,024 gigabytes

- If your computer has 1-TB, it can store almost **nine trillion bits**.
- Each bit holds a state that is a tiny part of a much larger piece of information.
 - e.g., text, picture, music, movie, or program.

BINARY: ENCODING AND DECODING

- Encoding: The process of converting information (e.g., text or image) to binary.
 - To process, store, or transmit information.
- Decoding: The process of converting binary to information.
 - To reconstitute information in a format we recognize.

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MACHINE LANGUAGE **COMMUNICATING WITH BINARY**

DEVELOPING A PROTOCOL

- Protocol: a set of rules that outline the foundation for digital communications and how bits are transmitted..
 - Bit size: number of bits per message.
 - Bit rate: number of bits that are transmitted per second (e.g., 1 bps).
 - Termination

- Example: **0110** What does it mean?
When to expect the next?

0

Is it a traffic light?

1

Is it red?

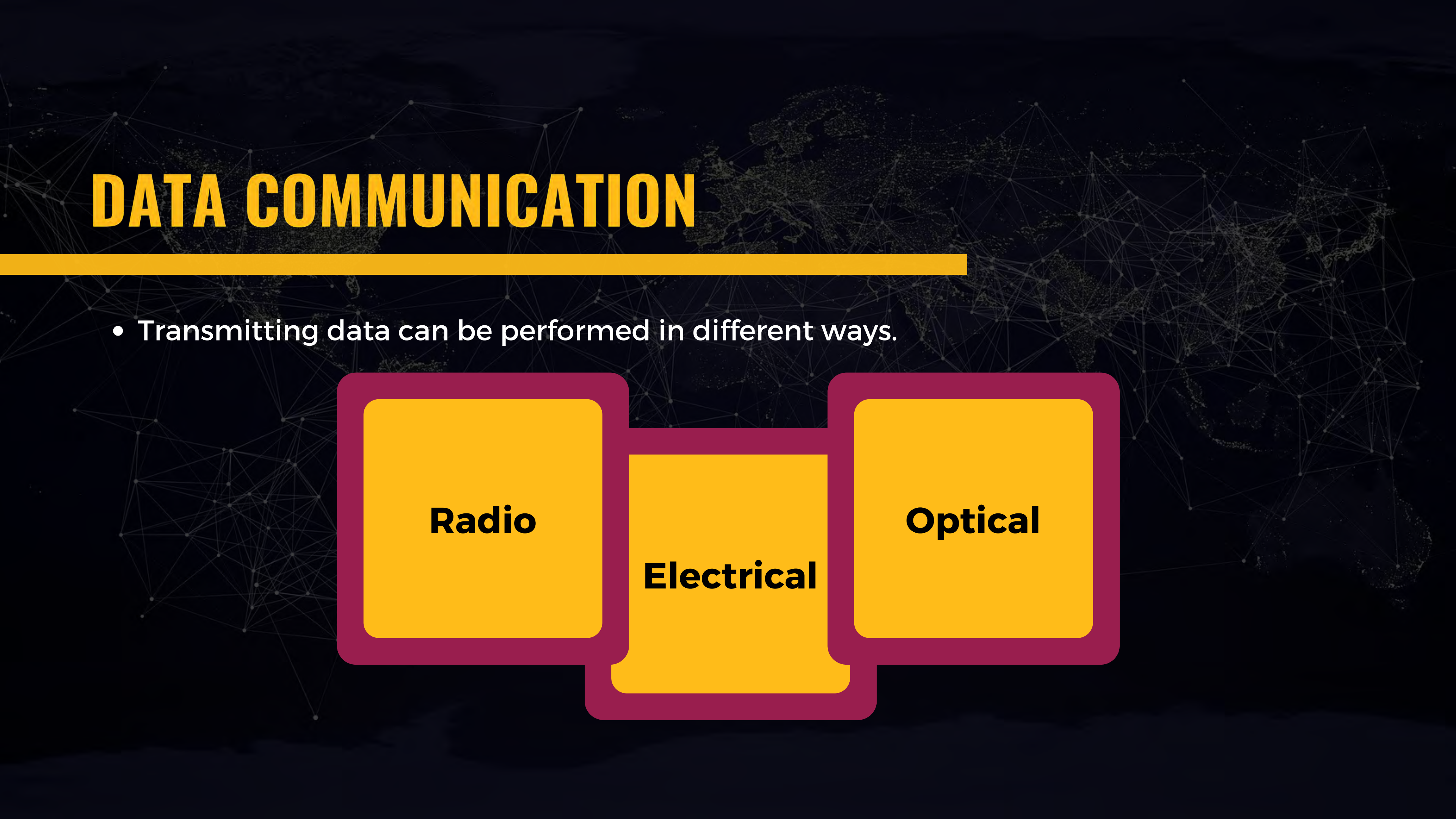
1

Is it on?

0

End communication?

DATA COMMUNICATION



- Transmitting data can be performed in different ways.

Radio

Electrical

Optical

RADIO: WI-FI NETWORKS

- Transmit binary states based on alternating the radio waves.
- The process:
 - Encodes to binary.
 - Transmits by varying radio waves.
 - Receives these waves
 - Decodes to binary
- Wi-Fi and radio communications work well for short distances.
 - Devices should be close to the connection hotspot.
- May encounter much interference and noise.
 - When having multiple hotspots.

RADIO: WI-FI NETWORKS

- Hotspots work with unique channels to minimize interference and noise.
- **2.4-GHz** frequency band
 - 14 channels designated for wireless networks.
 - Channels are spaced 5 MHz apart.
 - The protocol requires 25 MHz of channel separation
 - Channels 1, 6, 11 are typically used in the US.
- **5-GHz** frequency band
 - 42 channels designated for wireless networks.
 - Includes four bands: 5.1-GHz, 5.3-GHz, 5.4-GHz, and 5.8-GHz
 - Channels are non-overlapping.

ELECTRICAL NETWORKS

- Send electric pulses through wires/cables that represent binary states
 - For example, ethernet cable.
- This kind of networks makes the foundation of most communication.
 - For example, you may use the Wi-Fi but the hotspot is wired to a larger network.
- There are some limitations when considering long distances.
 - Limitations include speed and reliability.

OPTICAL OR LIGHT NETWORKS

- Send pulses of light through a cable of glass or plastic.
 - The speed of light through the glass:
 - 200,000 kilometers/s (124,000 mile/s)
- Optical cables are costly.
- These networks are used across continents and oceans.

Radio

Optical

ALL TOGETHER

Radio, electrical, and optical

We are able to communicate across the globe.
Even outside.



05 MINUTES DISCUSSION

For optical communication, how to encode on and off?

Well, like a light switch.

But what about having multiple zeros in a row to send?



SOME CONCEPTS

- The bit rate for a communication system is very important.
 - Example: with a bit rate 1 bit/s, when not having signal for
 - 1 second -> 0
 - 2 seconds -> 00
 - 3 seconds -> 000
- Other important concepts are: **bandwidth** and **latency**.

Radio

Optical

Bandwidth

The theoretical maximum that a transmission system can support.

- USB 3 port has **5 gigabits** (Gbps)
- USB 4 port has **40 gigabits** (Gbps)

Latency

The time to get a message from one place to another. Usually, in milliseconds (1/1000 of a second).



NUMBER SYSTEMS

NUMBER SYSTEMS

- **Numerical numbers:**

- Using decimal digits 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9
- Numbers use a base 10 for multiple digits.

- **Roman numerals:**

- Using symbols like I, V, X, L, C, and M
- There can be three consecutive symbols of the same type.
- I II III IV V VI VII VIII IX X
- L (50) C(100) D(500) M(1,000)

DECIMAL NUMBER SYSTEM

- Numbers use a **base 10** for multiple digits
- When reaching the highest digit and wanting to add one more.
 - Open a left column with one and set the current column to zero.



$$\begin{array}{rcl} 5 & \times & 10^0 = 5 \\ 1 & \times & 10^1 = 10^+ \\ 2 & \times & 10^2 = 200^+ \\ \hline & & = 215 \end{array}$$

OCTAL NUMBER SYSTEM

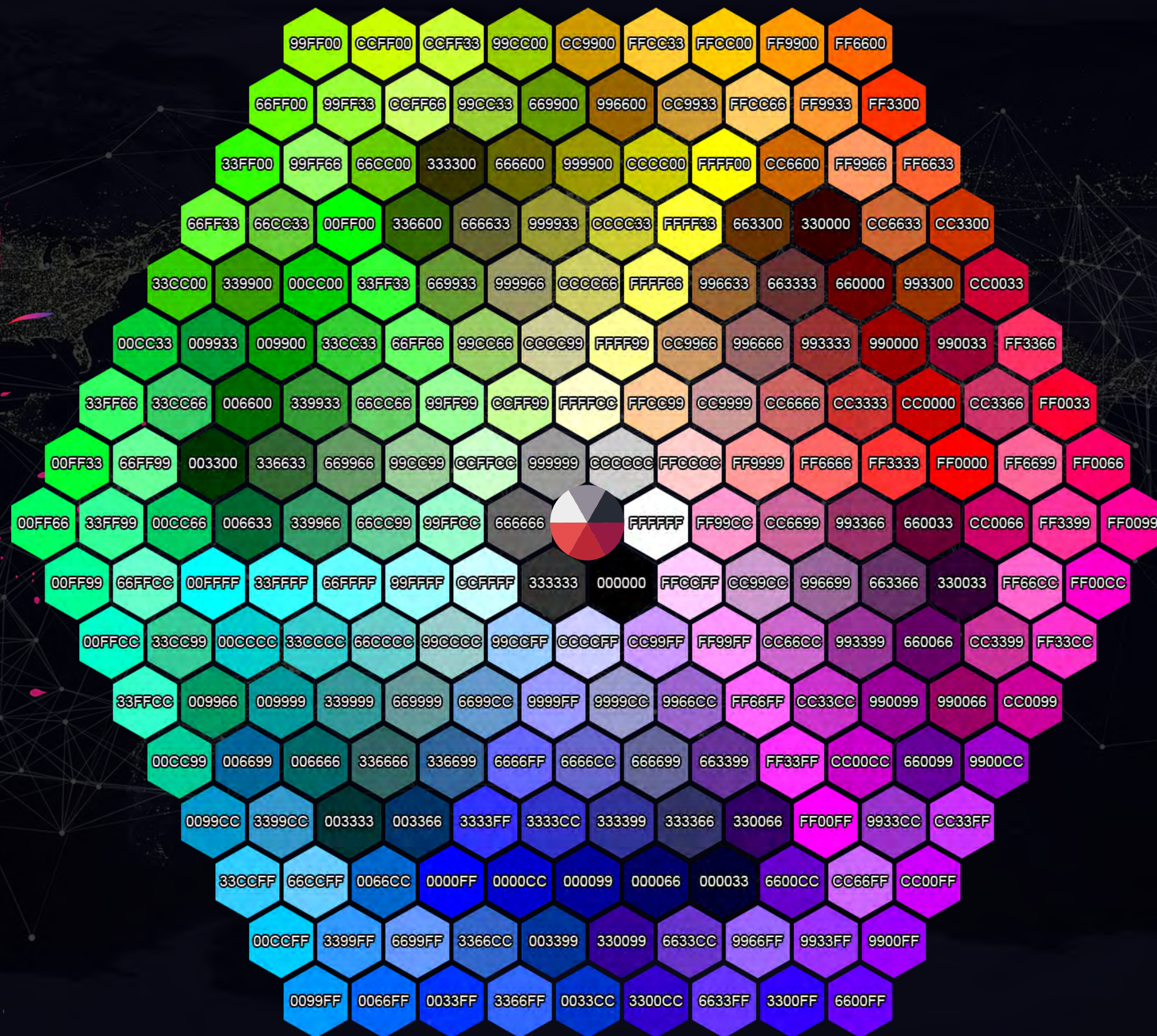
- Numbers use a **base 8** for multiple digits



$$\begin{array}{r} 3 \times 8^0 = 3 \\ 6 \times 8^1 = 48 + \\ 2 \times 8^2 = 128 + \\ \hline = 179 \end{array}$$

HEXADECIMAL NUMBER SYSTEM

- Numbers use a **base 16** for multiple digits
- After 9, use A, B, C, D, E, and F
- Often used for coding and web design.
 - Colors are represented by three or six hexadecimal numbers.
 - Representing red, green, and blue (**RGB**)



HEXADECIMAL NUMBER SYSTEM

16^4 16^3 16^2 16^1 16^0
0 A 3 7 E

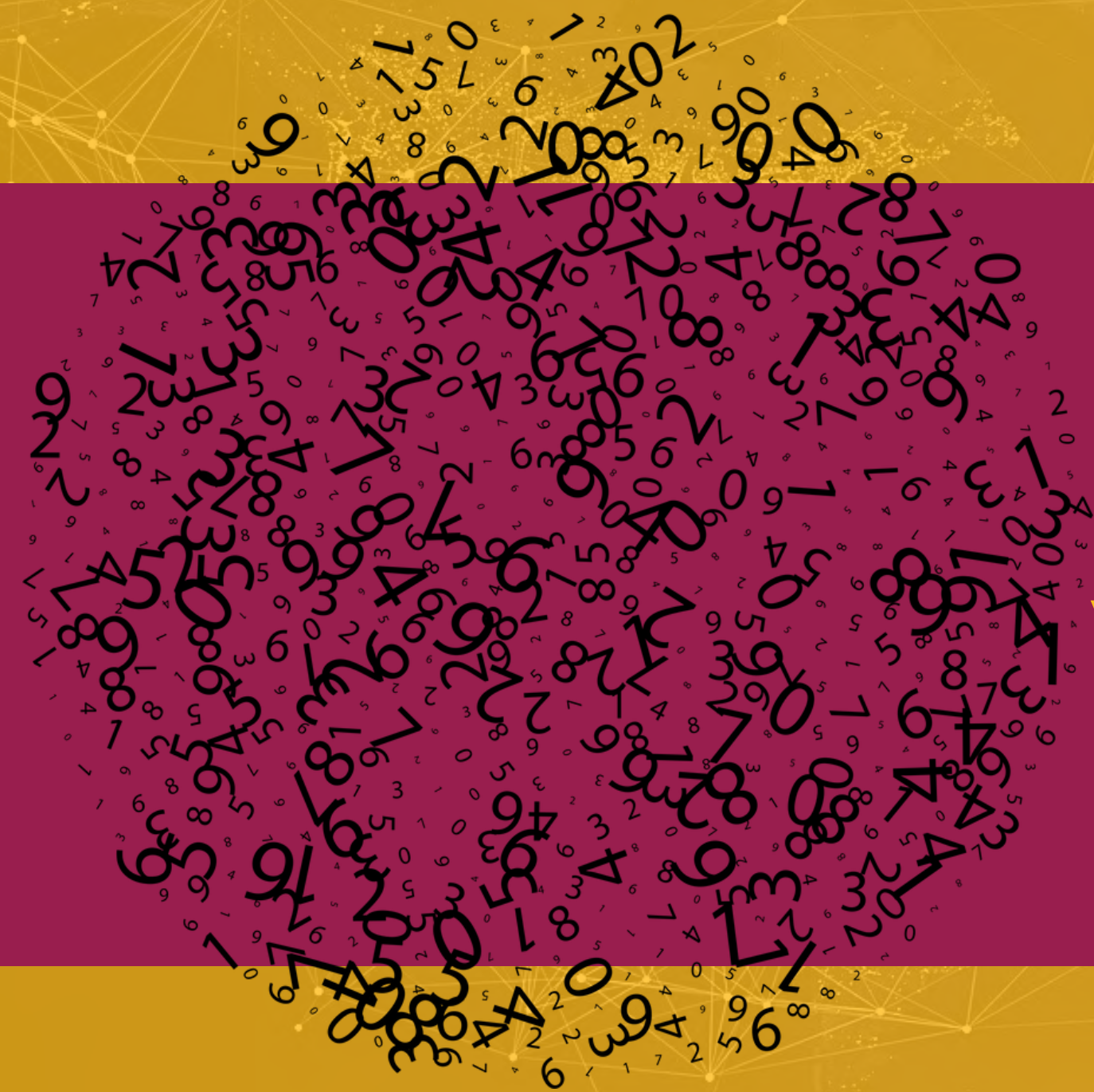
$$\begin{array}{rclcl} 14 & \times & 16^0 & = & 14 \\ 7 & \times & 16^1 & = & 112 & + \\ 3 & \times & 16^2 & = & 768 & + \\ 10 & \times & 16^3 & = & 40960 & + \\ \hline & & & & & = 41854 \end{array}$$

BINARY NUMBER SYSTEM

- Numbers use a **base 2** for multiple digits



0	x	2^0	= 0	+
1	x	2^1	= 2	+
1	x	2^2	= 4	+
1	x	2^3	= 8	+
				= 14



VALUES

BIT SIZE AND VALUES

- Binary represents numbers and values in a way the computer understands.
- Two binary digits can store a number with a maximum value of 3.
 - Increasing the digits increases the value we can store.
 - For example, 8-bit, 16-bit, 32-bit, 64-bit numbers
- **8-bit** can store values from 0 to 255.
 - A total options of values = $2^8 = 256$.
- **16-bit** can store values from 0 to 65,535.
 - A total options of values = $2^{16} = 65,536$.
- **32-bit** can store values from 0 to 4,294,967,295.
 - A total options of values = $2^{32} = 4,294,967,296$.

BIT SIZE AND VALUES

- The programmer should decide the size of memory required to store a value.
 - What is the most efficient way to store values?
- Most programming languages have different data types.
 - To support varying values.
 - Can be considered as containers.
 - For example:
 - **Boolean** value: 1-bit.
 - **Character** reference: 8-bit
 - Short **integer**: 8-bit
 - **Integer** number: 16-bit

NEGATIVE NUMBERS

- Signed numbers have a bit reserved for the positive or negative sign.
- For example, 8-bit signed number stores a value up to 127.
 - But the same range of values from -128 to 127.

SCALE AND CONSTRAINTS

- Consider an Excel spreadsheet:
 - Each cell is assumed to store a 64-bit value (8 bytes).
 - Excel can allow for more than:
 - 1,048,576 rows
 - 16,384 columns
 - i.e., more than 17 billion cells (17,179,869,184 cells)
 - Such a spreadsheet requires 137,438,953,472 bytes (**128 GB**).
- **Can this be loaded/opened in a phone device?**

SCALE AND CONSTRAINTS (OVERFLOW)

- No room to store a value in a reserved container.
 - Can generate an error.
 - For example, the error by the calculator when the result does not fit the screen.
 - Sometimes something else happens:
 - **186 + 92 = 22** (not 278)

1	0	1	1	1	0	1	0	186	
0	1	0	1	1	1	0	0	92	
1	0	0	0	1	0	1	1	0	22

A B C D E F G
H I J K L M
N O P Q R S T
U V W X Y Z

ENCODING TEXT

ASCII AND UNICODE

- **Can binary represent text?!**
- We can use a code for each letter and symbol.
 - **Encode:** represent the letter/symbol with its number.
 - **Decode:** use the number to get the letter/symbol.
- This encoding/decoding should be using the same code.
 - This is done with a **protocol**.



ASCII AND UNICODE

- Uppercase characters and lowercase characters
- Punctuation
- Common international (& Greek) characters,
- Special symbols
- Non-printed characters
 - Space, line return, backspace, and others.
- We have **256 characters**
 - We can encode these with **a single byte**.

ASCII AND UNICODE

The one-byte encoding system:

- is called ASCII
- American Standard Code for Information Interchange.
- Developed in the 1960s.

Dec	Hex	Oct	Char	Dec	Hex	Oct	Char	Dec	Hex	Oct	Char	Dec	Hex	Oct	Char
0	0	0		32	20	40	[space]	64	40	100	@	96	60	140	`
1	1	1		33	21	41	!	65	41	101	A	97	61	141	a
2	2	2		34	22	42	"	66	42	102	B	98	62	142	b
3	3	3		35	23	43	#	67	43	103	C	99	63	143	c
4	4	4		36	24	44	\$	68	44	104	D	100	64	144	d
5	5	5		37	25	45	%	69	45	105	E	101	65	145	e
6	6	6		38	26	46	&	70	46	106	F	102	66	146	f
7	7	7		39	27	47	'	71	47	107	G	103	67	147	g
8	8	10		40	28	50	(	72	48	110	H	104	68	150	h
9	9	11		41	29	51	)	73	49	111	I	105	69	151	i
10	A	12		42	2A	52	*	74	4A	112	J	106	6A	152	j
11	B	13		43	2B	53	+	75	4B	113	K	107	6B	153	k
12	C	14		44	2C	54	,	76	4C	114	L	108	6C	154	l
13	D	15		45	2D	55	-	77	4D	115	M	109	6D	155	m
14	E	16		46	2E	56	.	78	4E	116	N	110	6E	156	n
15	F	17		47	2F	57	/	79	4F	117	O	111	6F	157	o
16	10	20		48	30	60	0	80	50	120	P	112	70	160	p
17	11	21		49	31	61	1	81	51	121	Q	113	71	161	q
18	12	22		50	32	62	2	82	52	122	R	114	72	162	r
19	13	23		51	33	63	3	83	53	123	S	115	73	163	s
20	14	24		52	34	64	4	84	54	124	T	116	74	164	t
21	15	25		53	35	65	5	85	55	125	U	117	75	165	u
22	16	26		54	36	66	6	86	56	126	V	118	76	166	v
23	17	27		55	37	67	7	87	57	127	W	119	77	167	w
24	18	30		56	38	70	8	88	58	130	X	120	78	170	x
25	19	31		57	39	71	9	89	59	131	Y	121	79	171	y
26	1A	32		58	3A	72	:	90	5A	132	Z	122	7A	172	z
27	1B	33		59	3B	73	;	91	5B	133	[	123	7B	173	{
28	1C	34		60	3C	74	<	92	5C	134	\	124	7C	174	
29	1D	35		61	3D	75	=	93	5D	135	]	125	7D	175	}
30	1E	36		62	3E	76	>	94	5E	136	^	126	7E	176	~
31	1F	37		63	3F	77	?	95	5F	137	_	127	7F	177	

ASCII AND UNICODE

Encode



Hello to you

72 101 108 108 111 116 111 121 111 117

01001000 01100101 01101100 01101100 01101111 01110100 01101111 01111001 01101111 01110101

Decode



01001000 01100101 01101100 01101100 01101111 01110100 01101111 01111001 01101111 01110101

72 101 108 108 111 116 111 121 111 117

Hello to you

What about More letters, characters, and glyphs?

What about More letters, characters, and glyphs?



ASCII AND UNICODE



- **Unicode** was introduced to represent thousands of symbols from languages all around the world.
- Unicode uses multiple bytes to represents letters/symbols.

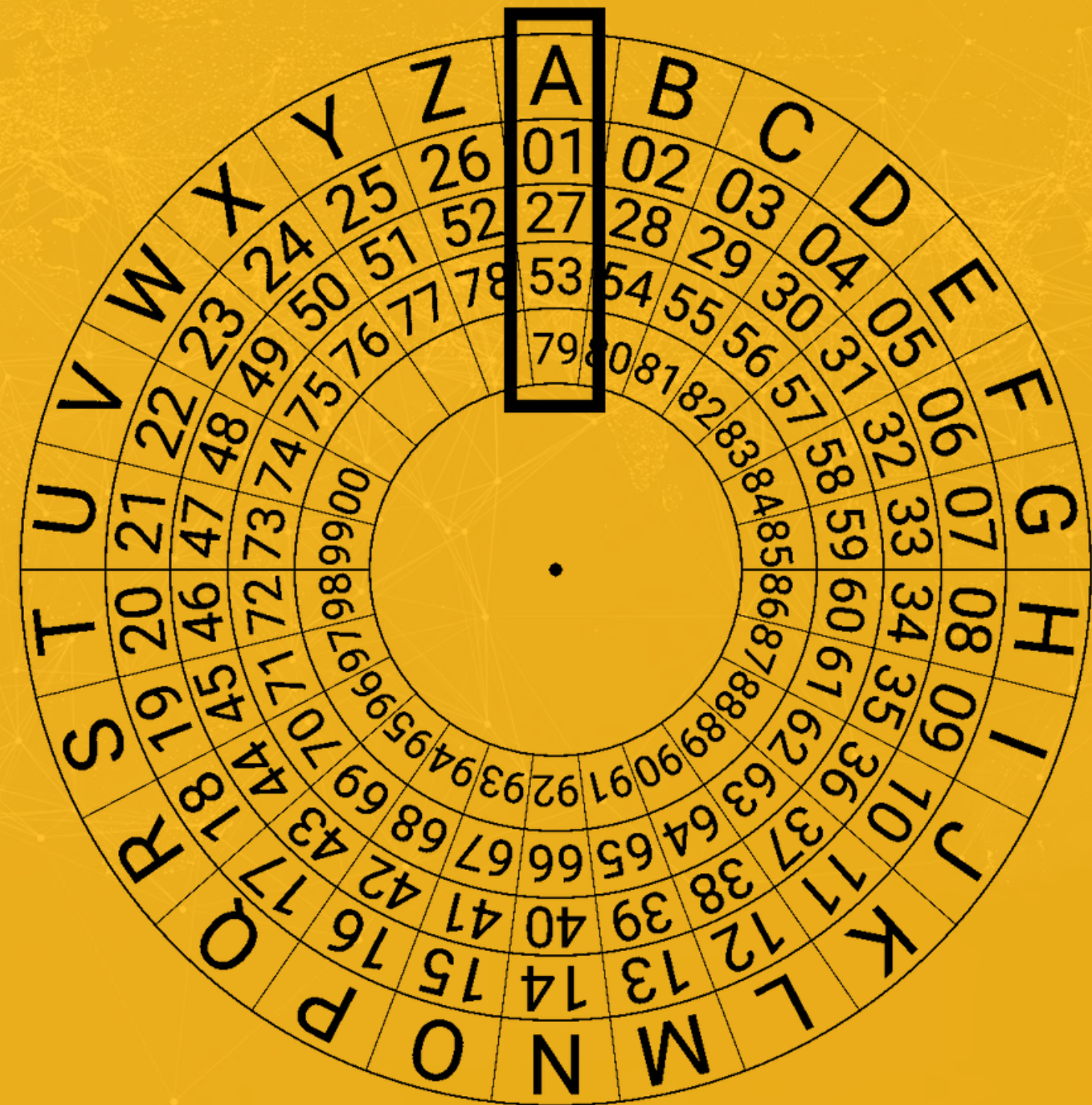
ASCII AND UNICODE

UTF-8 (8-bit Unicode Transformation Format)

- Compatible with ASCII
- Uses multiple planes (from 0 to 16 = 17)
- Uses a prefix U
- **Plane-0**
 - Uses a prefix U and then a four-digit hexadecimal number
 - Example: U0044 = D
 - It needs 16-bit (**2 bytes**)
 - Can represent more than **65,000 letters/symbols**.

WHAT ABOUT FORMAT?

Can we encode formatted text?



ENCODING FORMAT

- We use different formatting features to add additional meaning to the text.

Text can be in **bold**, *italic*, underline, different color, and many other formats.

- How does the encoding happen?

ENCODING FORMAT



- Usually, it is done with a markup language such as HTML.
 - Tags are used to mark the start and end of a format.
 - The text editor/browser uses these tags to provide structure to the document.
- Tags are encoded with UTF-8.

Text can be in **bold**, *<i>italic</i>*,
<u>underline</u>, and other format.



TEXT COMPRESSION

DATA MEASUREMENT

- The byte is the base form of measurement for data size.
- Data size is done by multiples of 1,024.
 - 1,024 bytes is a kilobyte (**KB**), can store (2-3 paragraphs).
 - 1,024 kilobytes is a megabyte (**MB**), can store (3-4 200-pages books).
 - 1,024 megabytes is a gigabyte (**GB**), can store (+4,000 books).
 - 1,024 gigabytes is a terabyte (**TB**), can store (+4,500,000 books).
 - Larger units:
 - Petabytes (**PB**), Exabytes (**EB**), Zettabytes (**ZB**), and Yottabytes (**YB**).

Large Files

Larger file size requires larger storage and transmission bandwidth and time.

Compression

Compression: makes the data space smaller while preserving the original data.

DATA COMPRESSION

DEFINITION

Data compression is the algorithmic problem of finding alternative, space-efficient encodings for a given data file.

- Compression requires a protocol defining the encoding and decoding method.
 - **Lossless:** recovered information from the compressed form is the same as the original.
 - Zip
 - **Lossy:** recovered data differs (**insignificantly**) from the original.
 - jpeg compression

TEXT COMPRESSION



- Text compression is done using lossless compression
 - **Codewords** and **Dictionaries** are used to eliminate redundant information.

TEXT COMPRESSION (EXAMPLE)

DICTIONARY

- 1.ASK
- 2.NOT
- 3.WHAT
- 4.YOUR
- 5.COUNTRY
- 6.CAN
- 7.DO
- 8.FOR
- 9.YOU

ORIGINAL TEXT

ASK NOT WHAT YOUR COUNTRY CAN DO FOR YOU
ASKWHAT YOU CAN DO FOR YOUR COUNTRY

ENCODED TEXT

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 1 3 9 6 7 8 4 5

TEXT COMPRESSION



- Multiple passes can be done to further compress the content.
 - To save space and time.
 - To allow for better analysis



ENDCODING IMAGES

IMAGES

- Images are based on individual pixels.
 - Bitmaps
 - Matrix of pixels
 - The height of an image defines the number of rows.
 - The width of an image defines the number of columns.
 - Each pixel holds a color.
 - **RGB (#000000)**
 - Each color (red, green, and blue) is given value .
 - A color value is a 2-digit hexadecimal number (**1 byte**).
 - These color values are encoded into binary.

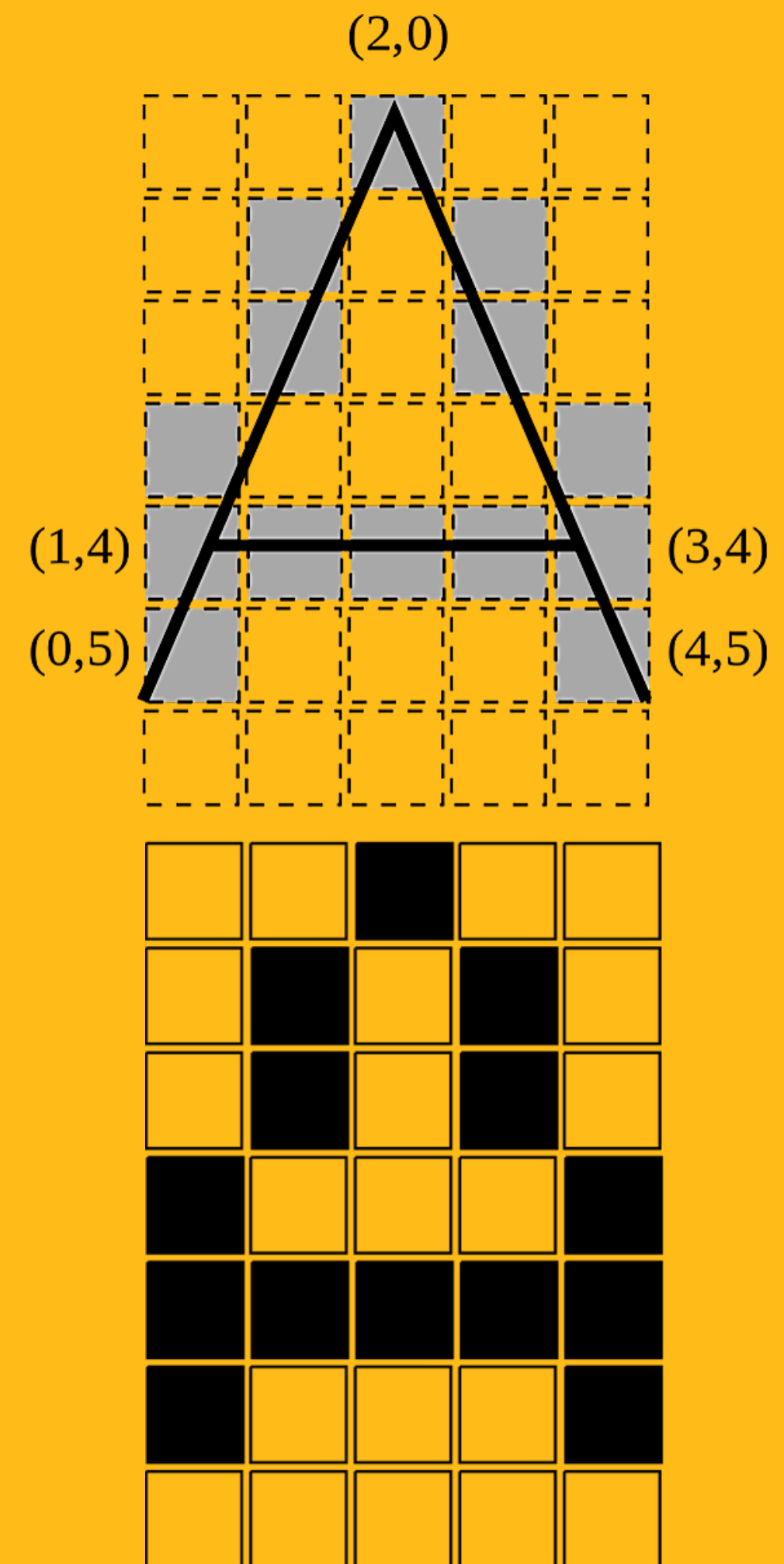


IMAGE RESOLUTION

- **HD RESOLUTION IMAGE**

- $1920 \times 1080 = 2,073,600$ pixels.
- $2,073,600 \times 3 \text{ bytes} = 6,220,800$ bytes
- 5.9326 megabyte

- **4K RESOLUTION IMAGE**

- Four times the size of an HD image.
- $3,840 \times 2,160, = 8,294,400$ pixels.
- $8,294,400 \times 3 = 24,883,200$ bytes
- 23.730 megabytes

IMAGE FILE



IMAGE FILES HAVE MORE INFORMATION THAN THE ACTUAL PIXEL VALUES.

- The origin
- Camera
- Date
- Owner
- etc.

SO THE FILE SIZE IS SLIGHTLY LARGER THAN THE IMAGE PIXEL INFORMATION.

VIDEO FILES

- **HD RESOLUTION VIDEO**

- 30 frames per second (could be more).
- $30 \times 6,220,800$ bytes (HD) = 186,624,000 bytes/second.
- $186,624,000 \times 60$ seconds = 11,197,440,000 bytes/minute.
- **10.428 gigabyte/minute.**

- **HOW ABOUT 4K VIDEO?**

- more than **41 gigabyte/minute.**
- That is the size without the audio or other information.

HOW TO ENCODE IMAGES?

BITMAPS

VECTORS

BITMAPS

- The most common image formats.
 - Display images on a computer monitor, printers, scanners, and similar devices.
- Bitmaps contain pixels.
- Example of file formats:
 - GIF, JPEG, PNG, TIFF, XBM, BMP, and PCX.



VECTORS

- Vector images are constructed using mathematical formulas.
 - Describing **shapes**, **colors**, and **placement**.
- Vector images consist of shapes, curves, lines, and text.
- Example of file formats:
 - **CMX** (Corel Metafile Exchange Image), **SVG** (Scalable Vector Graphics), **CGM** (Computer Graphics Metafile), **DXF**, and **WMF** (Windows Metafile).
- Resolution-independent.
- Maximum quality regardless of scale.

BITMAPS AND VECTORS

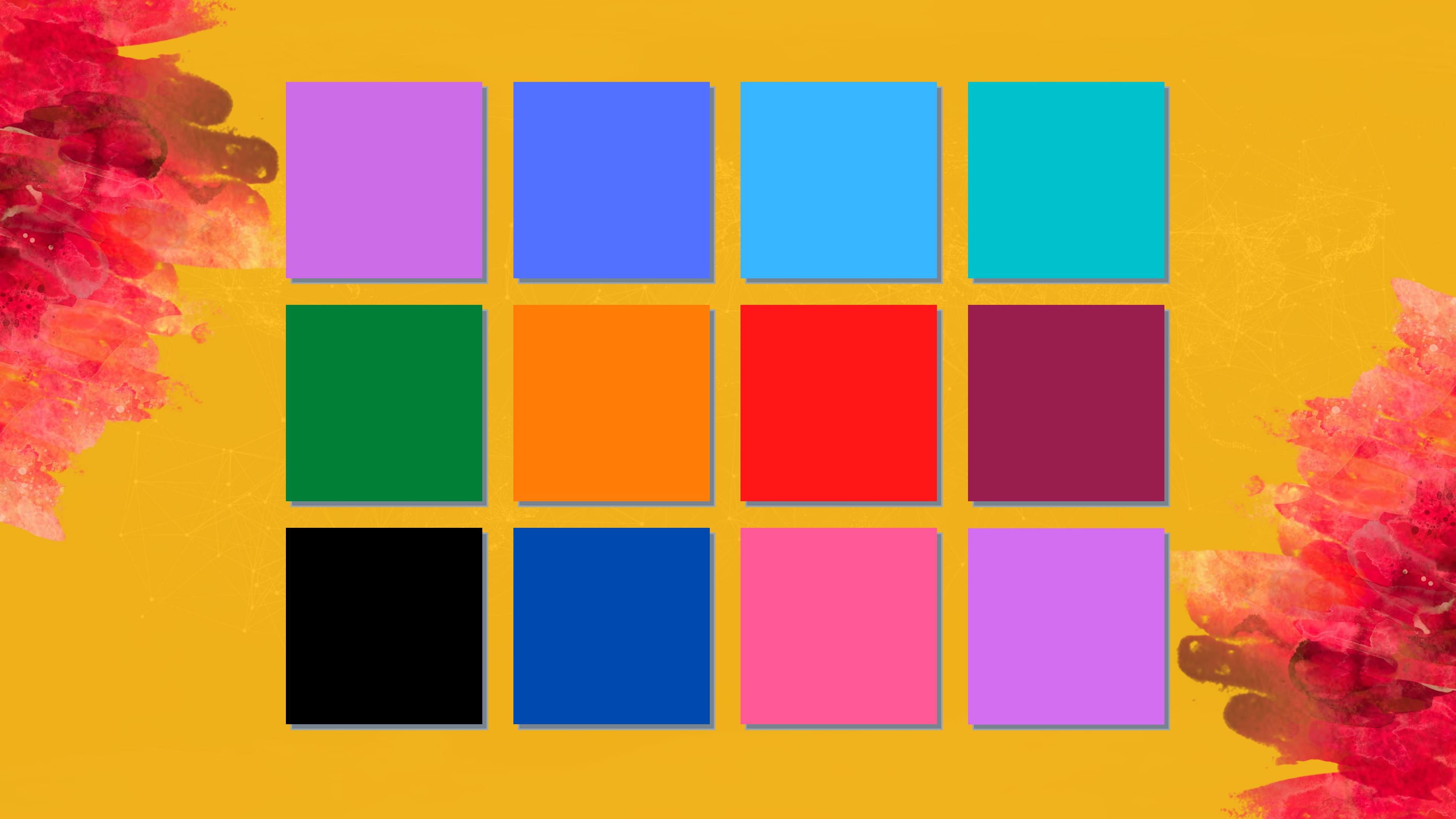
Web browsers and applications work with both formats.

IMAGE SIZE AND COLOR VARIATIONS

WHAT CAN WE DO TO REDUCE THE SIZE OF IMAGES?

Think of the number of colors that we can choose from!

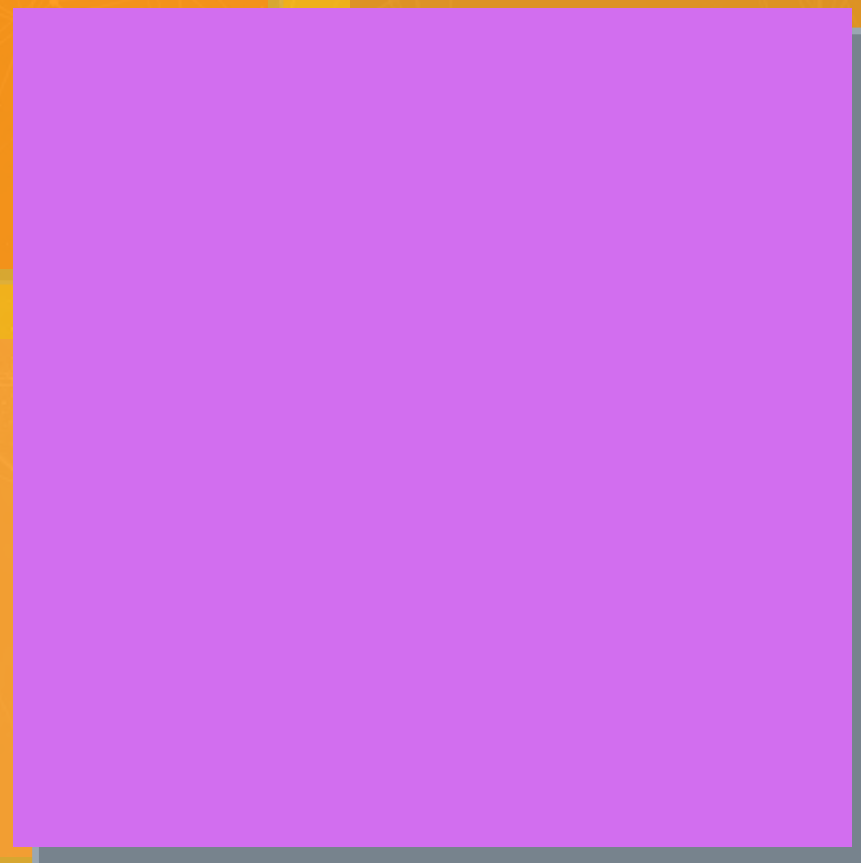
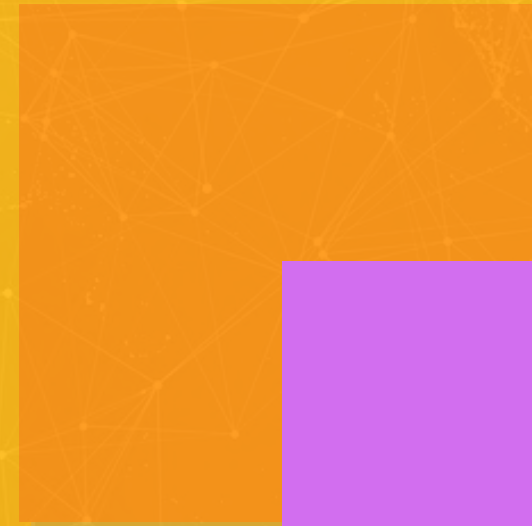
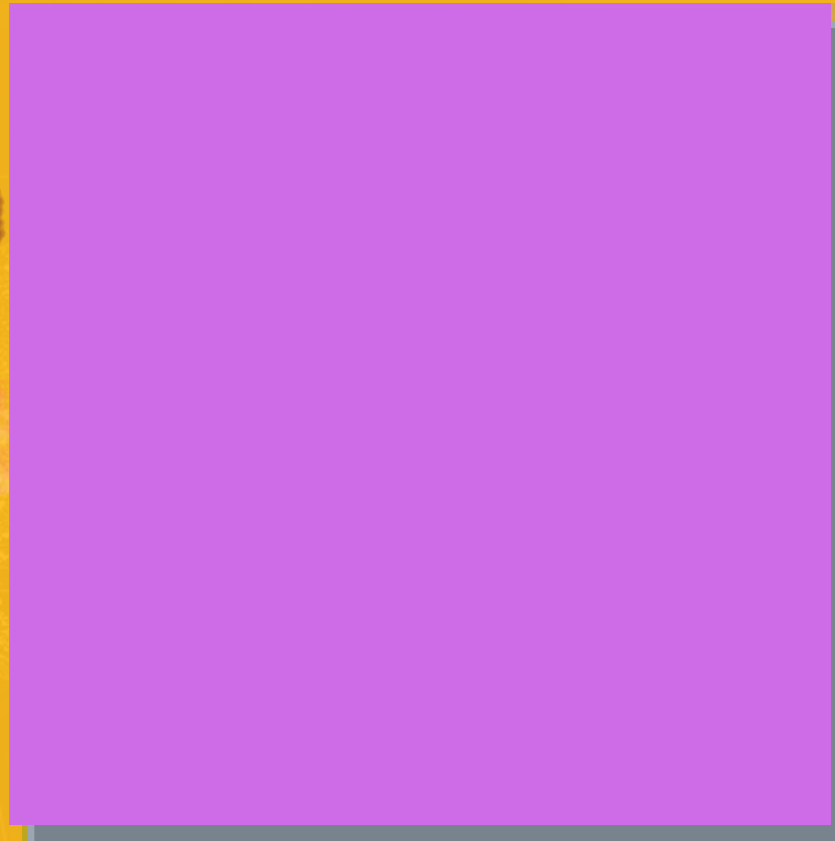
- Consider RGB 3-byte color range (e.g. #FFFFFF)



R: 205

G: 108

B: 230



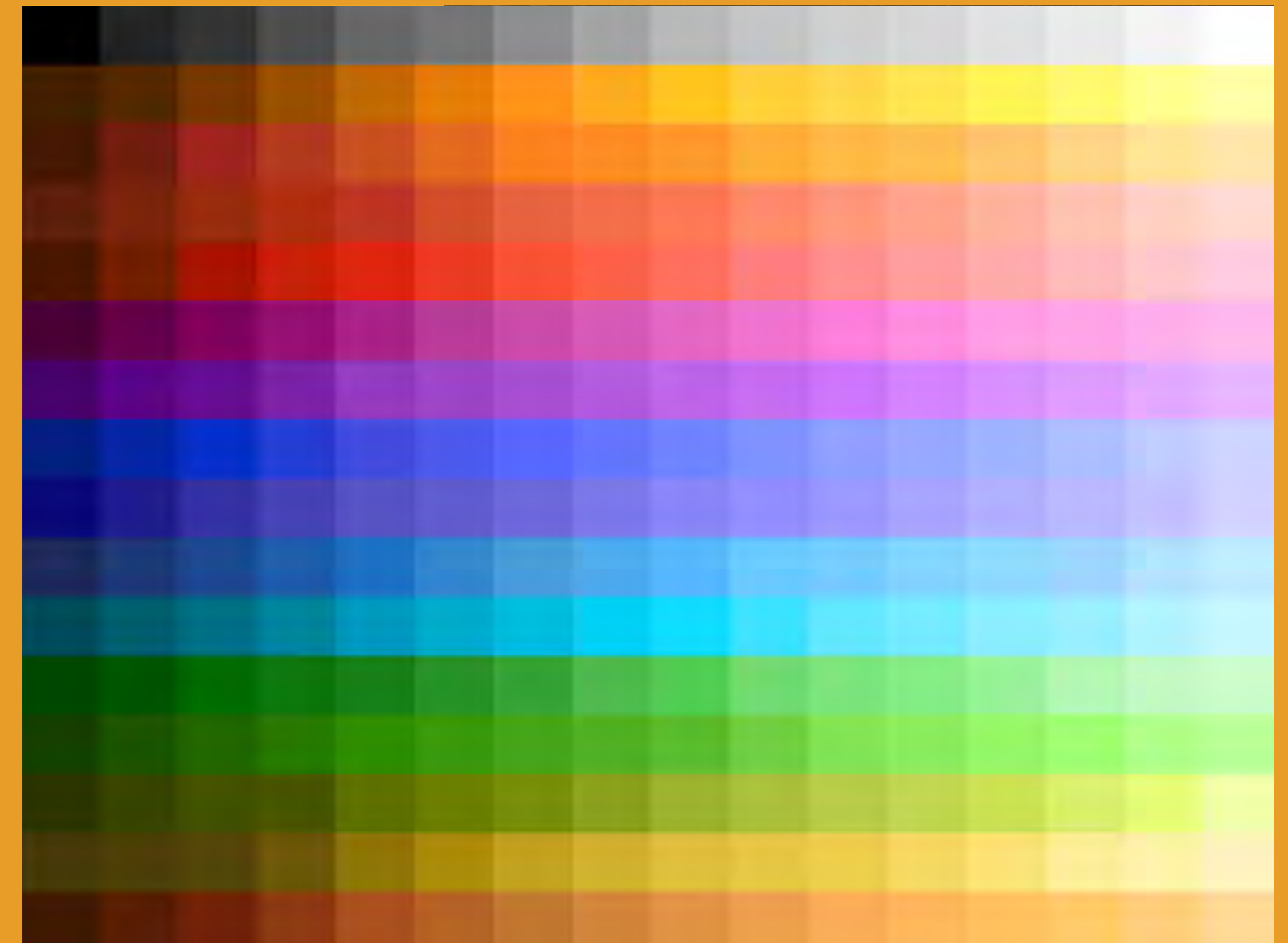
R: 210

G: 110

B: 239

GIF

- Reduce the number of color variations
- GIF uses a total number of **256 colors**.
 - Select from **24-bit color space**.
- This way the image can be compressed with a lossless compression.



JPEG

- JPEG Uses **lossy compression** to minimize the size of the image.
- Once compressed, the image cannot return to its original format.
- There are different levels for compression
 - From no loss to significant loss.

More compression



PNG

- PNG: Portable Network Graphics
- Improved version of the GIF format.
 - Pixels can contain 24-bit RGB color values or 32-bit values.
 - PNG also includes transparency.



OTHER IMAGE FORMAT

- Other formats and color systems are used for other purposes.
 - For example, print and photography.
 - **CMYK** (Cyan, Magenta, Yellow, and Black) are the primary colors for print.
 - Camera sensors capture light information in **RAW** format.
 - A program is used to translate RAW data into pixels.
- Image files can vary in type, context, and format.



END OF MODULE 1